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Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-265-23/24, **Version:** 1

Project Approval for the Canoga Park High School Major Modernization Project

May 7, 2024

Facilities Services Division

Action Proposed:

Approve the proposed Canoga Park High School Major Modernization Project (Project). The current Project budget is \$138,319,800.

Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of a Negative Declaration (ND). Pursuant to the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Guidelines, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project so that construction activities can commence at a later date. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board adopts the ND prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project.

Background:

On October 12, 2021, the Board approved the project definition for the due diligence, planning, and feasibility activities necessary to develop the scope, budget, and schedule for the proposed Project (Board Report No. 085-21/22). Subsequently, on November 15, 2022, the Board approved the redefinition of the proposed Project to incorporate its full scope, budget, and schedule (Board Report No. 074-22/23). This authorized staff to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed Project.

The proposed Project is located on a 21.38-acre school campus at 6850 Topanga Canyon Boulevard within the City of Canoga Park in the County of Los Angeles (Board District 3, Region North). Canoga Park High School (School) originally opened in 1914. All existing buildings were constructed between 1924 and 1977. As of the 2023-2024 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review, the school served approximately 1,460 students in grades 9 through 12.

The proposed Project will construct new facilities, including a two-story Food Services/Classroom Building with 12 classrooms and associated support spaces, food services, and student store; a new lunch shelter; a one-story Maintenance & Operations Building; and new covered walkways. The proposed Project also includes upgrades to the existing football field and running track to include replacing the existing dirt running track with a synthetic system, new natural grass field with irrigation, upgrades to the track features within the field, repairs to the bleachers, new home and visitors' restrooms and concessions, and a new scoreboard. The proposed Project also includes exterior painting for all remaining buildings and structures at the School, voluntary barrier removal, and infrastructure upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act. The

proposed Project will maintain the School's current capacity and total number of classrooms (78 classrooms).

The proposed Project includes the demolition of four permanent buildings (Cafeteria Building/Lunch Pavilion including attached covered walkway, Shop Building #1, Classroom Building #5, and Parent Center Building), seven relocatable classroom buildings, three restroom buildings, stadium ticket booth, existing running track, existing football field and irrigation, existing scoreboard, and miscellaneous storage buildings. Interim facilities will be installed to allow the School to remain operational and minimize impact during construction.

The proposed Project also includes utility upgrades; a new parking lot; new hardcourt play areas with striping and equipment; new outdoor learning environments; the removal and replacement of trees; landscaping and irrigation; hardscaping; fencing, gates, and site furnishings.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction activities related to the construction of new buildings are anticipated to begin in the first quarter of 2026, and site/utility/interim facilities activities may begin in advance of this work, in an earlier phase. Construction is anticipated to be completed in the second quarter of 2029.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with aging, deteriorating, and outdated buildings and grounds. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it adopted the project definition. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$138,319,800. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds targeted in the SUP for major modernizations, upgrades, and reconfigurations to school campuses.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will help ensure that the students attending the school are provided with safe and updated facilities that support learning.

Equity Impact:

The intent of the major modernization project is to address buildings and grounds that pose a safety concern and have the greatest need for upgrades with emphasis placed on seismic safety, reducing Los Angeles Unified's reliance on relocatable buildings, and addressing the most critical/severe physical conditions. While the proposed Project is extensive in nature, less critical items may not be addressed. This approach allows Los

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Angeles Unified to reach more schools with the limited funding available.

Issues and Analysis:

OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of a ND. The ND was circulated for a 30-day public review period from February 15, 2024, to March 15, 2024. The analysis documented in the IS/ND found that the proposed Project would not result in significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must adopt the ND and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

Attachments:

None.

Informatives:

None.

Submitted:

04/02/24

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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